



WP Ninja Finland 12.6.2026

Behind the Scenes - Crafting a Conference Winning Technical Session

Sami Laiho

CRO, MVP - Adminize Oy

Sami Laiho

Chief Research Officer / MVP

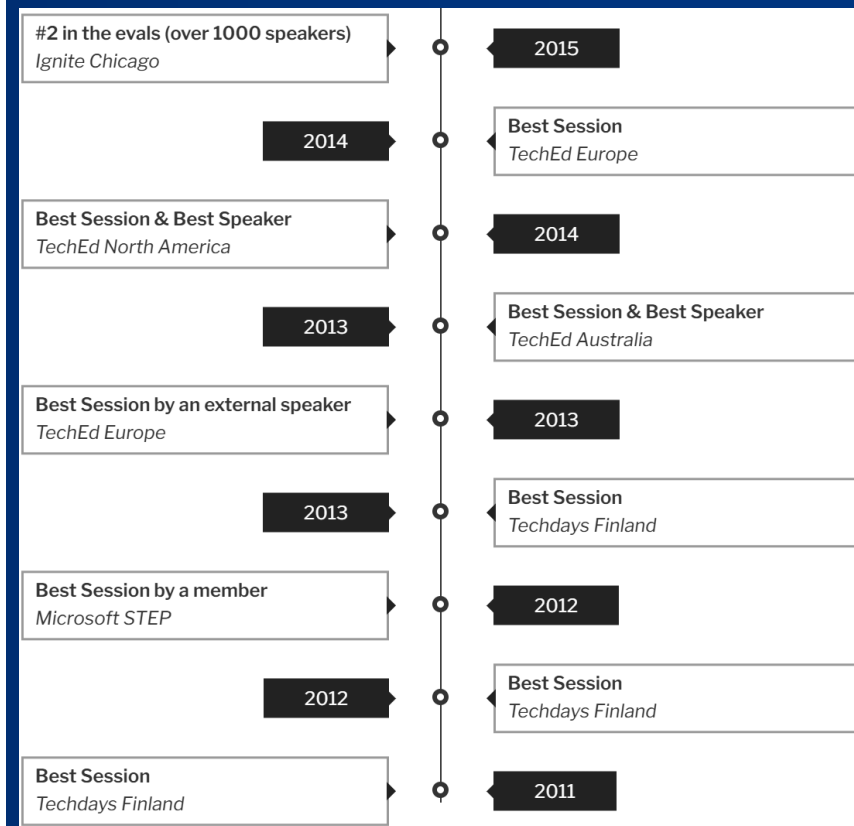
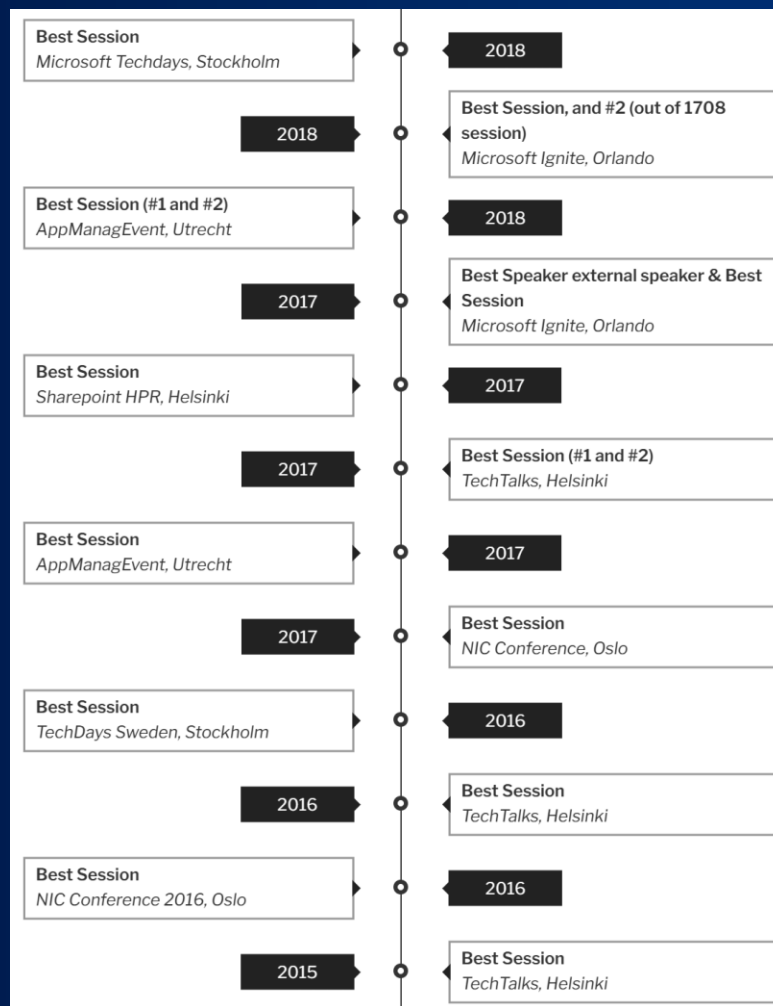
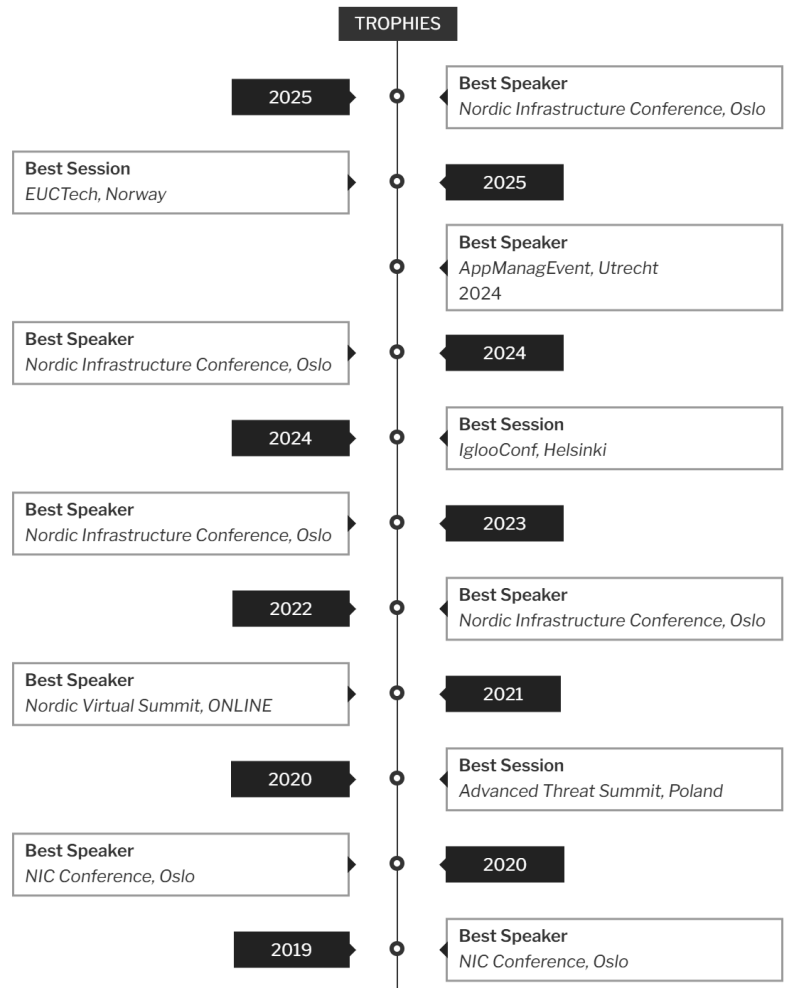
- IT Admin since 1995 / MCT since 2001
- Microsoft MVP in Windows OS since 2011, Security since 2024
- **"100 Most Influential people in IT in Finland" – TiVi'2019**
→
 - **Among Top 10 most followed techies on X/Twitter in Finland**
- Specializes in and trains:
 - Windows Internals
 - Security, Social Engineering, Auditing



Introvert



TROPHIES / MY PROFESSIONAL AWARDS



Biggest Achievement?





Getting in...

Event	Sessions	Call for Speakers
ESPC26 in 6 months 30 Nov - 3 Dec 2026	3/3 declined	finished 2 months ago
Declined State of the Cyber Union - Cybercrime in 2025 and Beyond		
Declined Cybersecurity - from Disabler to Enabler		
Declined 11 Ways to Hack Windows 11		
Scottish Summit 2026 in 4 months 2 Oct - 3 Oct 2026	2/2 declined	finished 42 days ago
Declined 11 Ways to Hack Windows 11		
Declined Cybersecurity - from Disabler to Enabler		
NDC Melbourne 2025 finished 14 months ago 29 Apr - 1 May 2025	2/2 declined	finished 19 months ago
Declined Forward to the Past and Back to the Future - Cybercrime in 2023/2024		
Declined Zero Trust - Dope or Nope?		

Chair's View



Talk to your audience

Thanks Mark Minasi

**Enthusiasm can't really be
faked, easily...**



Top 100 vs TOP 10

Session vs Show



AutoSave Off WCL322_BlackBelt_Troubleshooting_Windows8_Sami_Laiho - Last Saved 13/09/2018 16:20 Sami Laiho

File Home Insert Draw Design Transitions Animations Slide Show Review View Help Tell me what you want to do

Clipboard Slides Font Paragraph Drawing Editing Voice

37 Process diagnostics

38 Processes and threads

- In Windows a process can't really do anything
- Task Manager only shows processes
- Threads can actually do something
- Search engines probably know the answer to your question so the real problem with them is **noise**
- How to get rid of noise?
- Make your searches more accurate
- Make sure you get results from people who have at least a clue what they're doing
- Learn to diagnose threads instead of processes

39 Demo - Processes vs threads

40 Safemode etc.

41 How to access boot options in Windows 8

- Shift-Restart or
- Same if you want to goto your UEFI

Advanced startup

Start up from a device or disc (such as a USB drive or DVD), change your PC's firmware settings, change Windows startup settings, or restore Windows from a system image. This will restart your PC.

Restart now

PC settings

Personalize

Users

Notifications

Search

Share

General

Privacy

Devices

Wireless

Ease of Access

Sync your settings

HomeGroup

Windows update

Spelling

Autocorrect misspelled words

On

Highlight misspelled words

On

Language

Add or change input methods, keyboard, and other language preferences

Language preferences

Available storage

You have 24,0 GB available. See how much space you can free up

View app sizes

Refresh your PC with a clean install

If your PC isn't running well, you can refresh your PC with a clean install of Windows. This will delete all of your files, apps, and settings.

Get started

Remove everything and reinstall Windows

If you want to recycle your PC or start with a clean install of Windows, you can remove everything and reinstall Windows. This will delete all of your files, apps, and settings.

Get started

Advanced startup

Start up from a device or disc (such as a USB drive or DVD), change your PC's firmware settings, change Windows startup settings, or restore Windows from a system image. This will restart your PC.

Restart now

TechEd Australia 2013

Slide 41 of 50 English (Finland)

Notes 112%

16.29 13/09/2018

Story of Järjestelmävalvoja

- When hitting for #1, I choose jokes beforehand, and build the content around it



Storify Everything

“The phonology and grammar of Quenya are influenced by Finnish”
→ “He speaks Elvish”

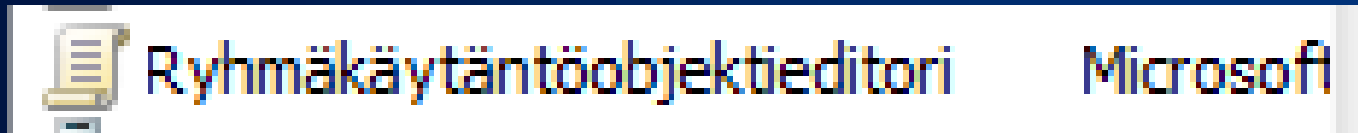


Can you spell this?

When you get Administrator
we get

JÄRJESTELMÄNVALVOJA

You get *gpedit.msc* and we get...



Making people remember you



Faeroese
QWERTY



Finnish
QWERTY



Finnish with Sami
QWERTY



French (Legacy, AZERTY)
AZERTY

Housekeeping



Admin Rights are not Human Rights

- US:
 - <https://www.zazzle.com/store/adminize>
- EU:
 - <https://www.zazzle.co.uk/store/adminize>





Storify everything

Empirical Research

- After years of extensive research I've done on teaching, I found out that:

People learn more if they are
awake!

I've been "Metood" as well

- Self intro
- Next s





There are only a few things...

- On Every training I've ever done, there are a few things that the evals say:
 - "The Teacher actually liked the stuff he spoke about"
 - "For once we had enough brakes"
 - "The teacher was realistic about Microsoft"
 - "The stories were great and on topic!"
 - "First time someone actually took time to explain the concepts and reasoning"



**Stories are good but WAR-stories
are better!**







**Add tips that get the “WOW”
effect**

Registry Editor

FileEditViewFavoritesHelp

Computer\HKEY_L

Add to Favorites...Remove Favorite...Image File Execution Options

GRE_InitialiHostActivitHostCompICMImage File IIniFileMapKnownFunKnownMarLanguagePLicensingDMCI ExtensMCI32MiniDumpMsiCorruptMultimediaNaAuthNetworkCaNetworkLisNolmeMocNotificationNowPlayinNtVdm64OEMOpenGLDriPeerDistPeerNetPerflibPerHwldStcPortsPrefetcherPrintProfileListProfileNotilProfileSani

Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Image File Execution Options

TypeData

REG_SZ(value not set)

Task Manager

Type a name, publisher, or PID to search

ProcessesPerformanceApp historyStartup appsUsersDetailsServicesSettings

Details

Name	PID	Status	User name	CPU	Memory (ac...	Thr...	Architec...	Description
System Idle Process	0	Running	SYSTEM	71	8 K	24		Percentage of time...
g2mlauncher.exe	23960	Running	SamiLaiho	12	2 964 K	25	x86	GoToMeeting
OneDrive.exe	50808	Running	SamiLaiho	02	133 076 K	42	x64	Microsoft OneDrive
OneDrive.exe	46000	Running	SamiLaiho	02	133 288 K	48	x64	Microsoft OneDrive
g2mcomm.exe	23736	Running	SamiLaiho	02	6 016 K	61	x86	g2mcomm.exe
Taskmgr.exe	39604	Running	SamiLaiho	01	87 696 K	39	x64	Task Manager
System	4	Running	SYSTEM	01	12 K	326		ntoskrnl.exe
dwm.exe	1808	Running		01	314 104 K	22		Dwm
msedgewebview2.exe	31112	Running	SamiLaiho	01	323 536 K	27	x64	Microsoft Edge W...
svchost.exe	4060	Running		01	17 848 K	23		Svchost
tailscaled.exe	11280	Running		00	69 100 K	83		Tailscaled
MsSense.exe	8584	Running		00	103 284 K	45		MsSense
appcservice.exe	8248	Running		00	48 452 K	20		Appcservice
csrss.exe	1152	Running		00	1 940 K	15		Csrss
msedge.exe	23052	Running	SamiLaiho	00	78 868 K	28	x64	Microsoft Edge
tailscale-ipn.exe	24664	Running	SamiLaiho	00	17 960 K	19	x64	Tailscale GUI client
WUDFHost.exe	6092	Running		00	5 404 K	25		WUDFHost
dasHost.exe	6124	Running		00	5 776 K	13		DasHost
Signal.exe	4936	Running	SamiLaiho	00	144 392 K	40	x64	Signal
svchost.exe	6896	Running		00	1 652 K	10		Svchost
MsMpEng.exe	9088	Running		00	206 556 K	43		MsMpEng
audiodg.exe	43916	Running		00	23 416 K	29		audiodg.exe
services.exe	1284	Running		00	6 280 K	8		Services
WmiApSrv.exe	6936	Running		00	1 536 K	3		WmiApSrv
explorer.exe	4580	Running	SamiLaiho	00	140 204 K	113	x64	explorer.exe
msedgewebview2.exe	43560	Running	SamiLaiho	00	16 364 K	56	x64	WebView2 Manager
appchelper.exe	7384	Running	SamiLaiho	00	688 K	3	x64	appchelper.exe

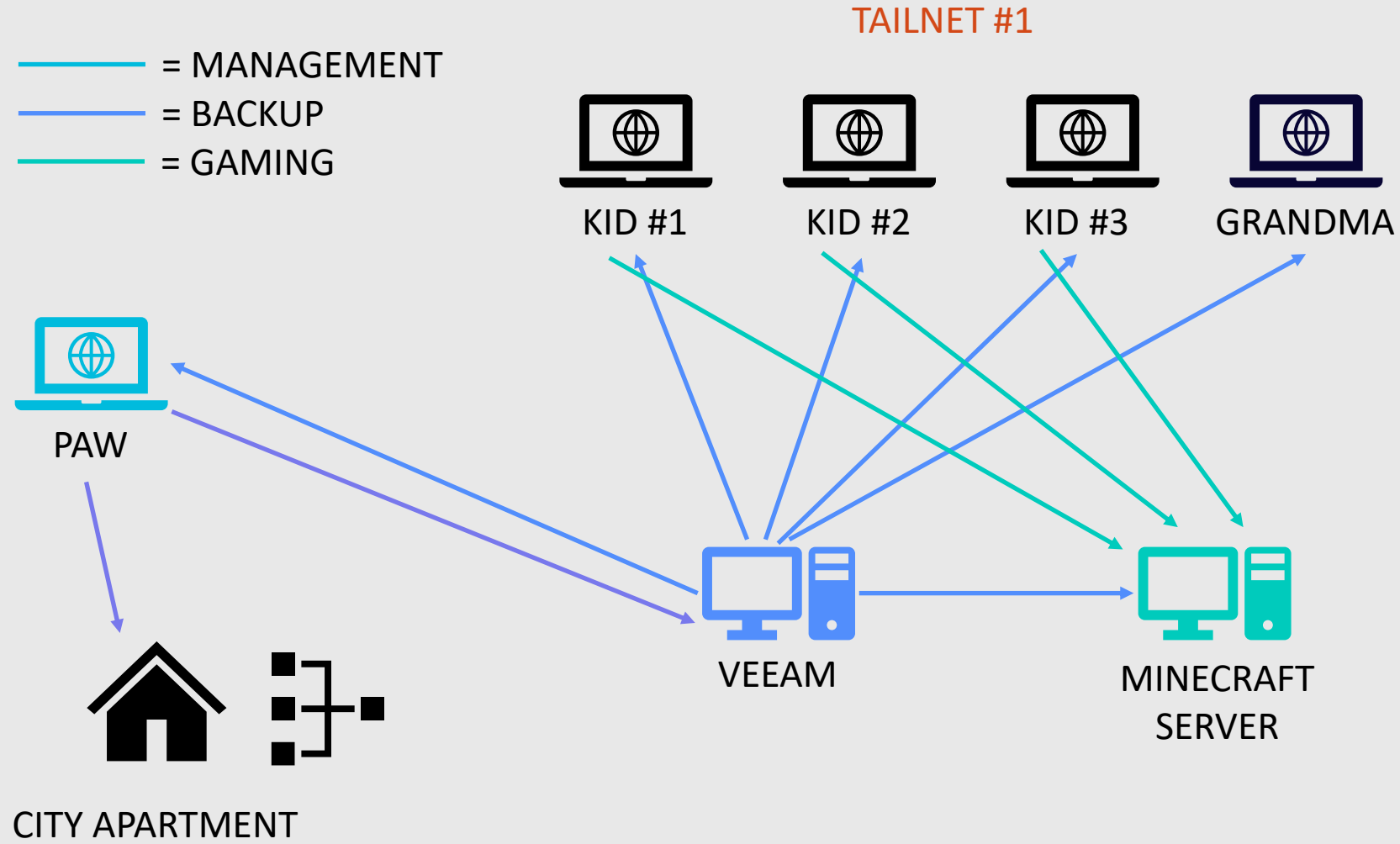
- Companies need ROI for sending people to conferences
- Peoples' hearts are won by giving something personal

Personal

- This way your computer works better
- This way you can watch free Netflix
- This way you can have your WLAN work better
- This way you can reset the password your grandma forgot
- This way you can protect your family
- This is how to build a free Wireguard VPN
- This is how you can limit kids admin-rights while Steam will still upgrade

Zero Trust with my Children





TAILNET #2

— = TRUE ZERO TRUST



WIFE

Stereotypes

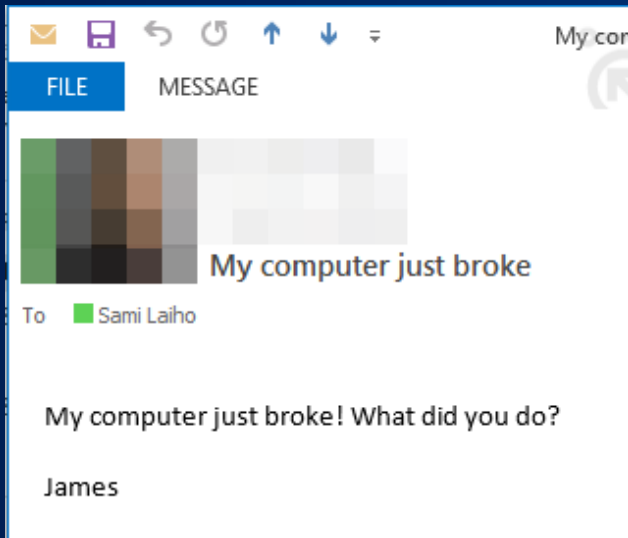


Remember to Cater for Different age Groups

Not just 40y80m olds...



What you need #1 – Good error reports!



CHAN = 0x80F55FE8, DEV 0

xxx STOP: 0x0000000A (0x0000258, 0x000000C, 0x0A1F000?)
 IRQL_NOT_LESS_OR_EQUAL xxx ADDRESS 80120748 HAS DATE AT 80120000=UNIDATA.SYS

DLL BASE	DATESTAMP	F.1.3	IRQL:C	SYSVER	0xF0000545
80100000	4074000	-	NTOSKRNL-EXE	DLL	BASE DATESTAMP - NAME
0A220000	4688000	-	UN.ATA.SYS	80007000	356876728 - HAL-RECE
88800000	7786000	-	DSSK.SYS	8007200	356876666 - SCSIPOUT.SYS
00070000	7578800	-	SECAL.SYS	8801345	72667160 - CLASS2.SYS
231F8768	88007678	-	NELOGFG.SYS		
297F8768	72240007	-	FS.SYS		
00001234	70002866	-	MTFS.SYS		

ADDRESS	WORD	DUMP	BURD [1387]	NAME
EB813348	80120007	80672222	777766602	1222 K66
EB813529	8012000A	80772221	77776601	3377887
EB813570	80120003	80772222	777766728	17118972
EB81352A	80120004	80772226	77776666	11117236
EB81352B	80120005	80772229	77776666	00006263
EB81357C	80120006	80772224	77777777	77078217
EB813570	80120007	80772227	77778861	11007432
EB81357E	80120008	80772226	77778863	11667214
EB81357F	80120009	80772224	77778862	07707133
EB813580	8012000A	80772227	77779071	88887238



Demos that people remember

Most know where this is going...







2 Factor Authentication!

Smart Cards are difficult,
Virtual Smart Cards will be deprecated... So let me introduce the Future of 2FA.....

Name: Token

Token Type: Live, Hedgehog

Token lifetime: 5-8 years

Tamper Protection: Yes



Tip

- Great content can be copyrighted — act it out!
- Missing Memes — Create them yourself





The Power of Silence

Disclaimer

- I purposely build material to win conferences
- I purposely build totally different material for making students learn



CHECKLIST FOR WINNING SESSIONS

- I love (at least like) what I'm talking about
- Selling/Cool Title for the session
- Jokes added, self-irony as a recommended approach
- Localized and current content
- (WAR)Storified the content as much as possible
- Something personal for attendees to take to work and home
- Taught something that 80% don't know
- Proved that you are critical and not marketing
- "AHAA" moment!
- Reminding about the importance of evals